

SOC alert triage playbook

Applies to SENTRIQ 4.2. For SOC tier 2. NOC tier 1 escalates detection alerts here; this playbook decides what to do with them.

Triage order

Work alerts in this order regardless of arrival time:

1. Alerts on tamper protection or the agent itself.
2. Alerts on admin or service accounts.
3. Alerts correlated across more than one endpoint.
4. Everything else, by severity.

An alert on tamper protection means something tried to disable the agent. Treat it as active until proven otherwise; it outranks a higher-severity alert elsewhere.

Deciding the disposition

Disposition	Condition	Action
True positive	Confirmed malicious or policy-violating	Contain, then follow incident response
False positive	Verified benign (see D14)	Mark as a false positive, tune if the rule is noisy
Benign true	Real but authorised (admin tool, pentest)	Suppress with an expiry, note the authorisation
Needs data	Cannot decide from the alert alone	Pull the process tree and raw telemetry

Pulling context

An alert is a summary. The decision usually needs the raw telemetry behind it:

```
sentryctl detect timeline --alert <alert-id>
```

This requires the soc-analyst role — a noc-operator sees an empty panel here, which is the most common handover confusion (see D16 on roles).

Containment

If the disposition is true positive and the host must be isolated:

```
sentriqctl respond isolate --endpoint <id> --reason "<ticket>"
```

Isolation cuts the host off the network but keeps the agent's link to the collector, so telemetry continues during investigation. Lift it with `respond release`.

Correlation across endpoints

An alert that fires on many endpoints at once is either a real campaign or a noisy rule. Check the rule's recent false-positive rate before assuming a campaign; a rule that suddenly fires everywhere after a deploy is usually the deploy, not an attacker (see D11 on rule failures).

When to escalate beyond SOC

- Confirmed compromise of an admin account.
- Tamper protection defeated, not just attempted.
- A detection gap: alerts that should have fired and did not.

Component owner: **Nguyễn Thị Lan** (Detection team).